“Do you remember Juliette?” said Léa. “The woman I met at the camp in Jargeau? I told you about her.”

“The prostitute with a three-year-old boy?”

“Yes. She sold herself to men to protect and feed her child. Then she came to Germany, thinking it was better to work in a factory for the enemy than as a prostitute.”

“Why are you speaking about her?”

“When Juliette told me her story—” Léa glanced at the sky “—it changed everything for me. If she could sell her body to protect her child, then I could come to Germany to protect you. Don’t you see that we’re the lucky ones? Our choices are terrible but we still have the luxury of choice. We can choose to take the difficult path, the one we don’t want but which can help others.”

Rose couldn’t believe what Léa was suggesting. “Are you saying I should pretend to have a relationship with Reinhardt, a man I detest, and somehow it will help others. Who will it help?”

“No, Rose. I am not saying that.” Léa pointed to the tomatoes in the basket. “But in a way, it’s what you’ve been doing already, giving the privileges he offers you to others.” She took a breath. “Now you could do it with more intention. The Polish women need food, clothes and medicine. You’ve seen how they struggle, how they’re treated. It’s almost winter. We won’t have much more to supplement their rations.” She touched Rose’s shoulders with both her hands. “Imagine how much more we could do for these women with *his* help. We can’t feel afraid when we’re thinking of others.”

Rose stepped back and buried her head in her hands. “You know he’ll want something from me in return.” Her voice quavered. “What will I do then?”

Léa winced. “The thought of him— It’s terrible. So you must think of all the people that you’ll be helping. Reinhardt would never want a Polish or Russian woman. You have power, Rose. And if you use it to do good, then you have nothing to fear.”

A terrible sinking feeling overcame Rose. As much as she hated to admit it, deep in her heart, she knew Léa was right.